



# Blossom time

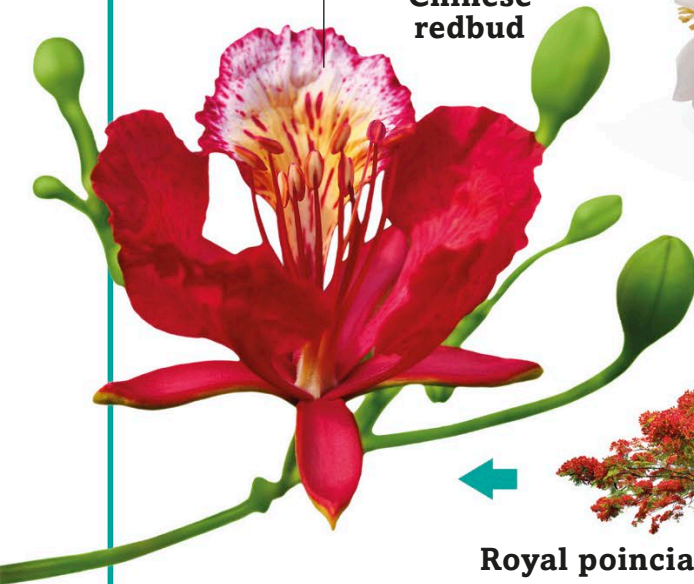


*Pink flowers grow in clusters in spring, and produce purple seed pods.*



*This upright petal guides pollinators to the nectar.*

**Chinese redbud**



**Royal poinciana**



*These beautiful flowering branches spread out and provide shade in hot, tropical environments.*



**Laburnum**



*Showers of yellow flowers give this tree its other name, "golden rain."*



**Mock orange**

*The fragrant flowers of this shrub contain oils used in perfumes.*



## NATURAL DYE

In 2018, scientists created a natural dye using the bright red flowers of the royal poinciana tree. This dye can be used to color silk and cotton fabrics.



Blossom is the name for the flowers that grow on trees and bushes, which often produce colorful displays in spring and summer. Changes in temperature and day length signal to the plant when to bloom. When pollinated, blossoms grow into fruits.

Some trees, such as **blackthorn** and **magnolia**, begin to flower even before their leaves unfurl, which may help pollinators find their flowers more easily. After pollination, fruits such as **mock oranges** and **apples**, as well as seed pods of trees such as **laburnum**